

FYBCA Semester 2 — Complete Exam Notes

Subject 7: English — Written Communication

KBCNMU | Exam: 30 Marks | Complete Notes

TOPIC 1: Types of Communication

1.1 What is Communication?

Communication is the process of exchanging information, ideas, thoughts, or feelings between a sender and a receiver through a medium. Effective communication is clear, concise, correct, complete, and courteous.

1.2 Types of Communication

Type	Description	Examples
Verbal Communication	Using spoken or written words to communicate.	Speech, interviews, letters, emails, reports
Non-Verbal Communication	Using gestures, facial expressions, body language, visuals.	Nodding, hand gestures, posture, eye contact
Written Communication	Communicating through writing.	Letters, emails, memos, reports, notices
Oral Communication	Communicating through speaking.	Conversations, presentations, phone calls
Formal Communication	Official communication following prescribed channels.	Official letters, reports, notices, memos
Informal Communication	Unofficial, casual communication.	Conversations with friends, grapevine
Upward Communication	Communication from lower to higher level.	Employee to manager report
Downward Communication	Communication from higher to lower level.	Manager's instructions to employees
Horizontal Communication	Communication between people at the same level.	Team members discussing a project

1.3 Elements of Communication

Element	Description
Sender	The person who initiates/creates the message.
Message	The information, idea, or content being communicated.
Encoding	Converting the message into words, symbols, or gestures.
Channel/Medium	The means through which the message is sent (email, phone, letter).
Receiver	The person who receives and interprets the message.

Decoding	Interpreting/understanding the message by the receiver.
Feedback	Receiver's response to the message — confirms if understood correctly.
Noise	Any interference that distorts the message.

TOPIC 2: Formal Communication — Letters and Emails

2.1 Formal Letter Writing

A formal letter is an official letter written in a professional format for business, government, or academic purposes.

2.2 Format of a Formal Letter

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[Your Address]
[Date]

[Recipient's Name]
[Designation]
[Organization]
[Address]

Subject: [Brief subject line]

Salutation: Dear Sir/Madam,

[Opening paragraph – state purpose]

[Body paragraphs – details, supporting points]

[Closing paragraph – action expected, thank you]

Yours faithfully/sincerely,
[Your Signature]
[Your Name]
[Designation]
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2.3 Types of Formal Letters

Type	Purpose
Application Letter	Applying for a job, admission, loan, etc.
Complaint Letter	Filing a complaint to an authority.
Request Letter	Requesting permission, information, or assistance.
Inquiry Letter	Seeking information about products/services.
Official Letter	Communication between government departments.
Resignation Letter	Formally resigning from a position.

2.4 Email Writing

A formal email follows the same principles as formal letters but uses digital format.

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To: recipient@email.com
CC: [others if needed]
Subject: [Clear and specific subject line]

Dear [Name/Sir/Madam],
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Opening: State purpose clearly.

Body: Explain details. Keep it concise.

Closing: What action is expected?

Regards,

[Your Name]

[Contact Information]

TOPIC 3: Barriers to Communication

3.1 Types of Barriers

Type	Description	Examples
Physical Barriers	Environmental obstacles that prevent communication.	Noise, distance, technical problems, bad connection
Semantic Barriers	Problems in language, meaning, or interpretation.	Jargon, ambiguous words, different meanings
Psychological Barriers	Mental/emotional obstacles affecting communication.	Stress, fear, prejudice, lack of attention
Cultural Barriers	Differences in culture, traditions, values.	Different meanings for same gesture in different cultures
Organizational Barriers	Structural problems within organizations.	Rigid hierarchy, too many levels, overload
Language Barriers	Difficulty due to different languages or vocabularies.	Technical jargon, foreign language
Physiological Barriers	Physical limitations of sender or receiver.	Hearing impairment, speech problems

3.2 Overcoming Communication Barriers

- Use simple, clear language — avoid jargon.
- Listen actively and provide feedback.
- Choose the right channel for the message.
- Be aware of cultural differences.
- Reduce physical noise in the environment.
- Be empathetic — understand the receiver's perspective.
- Confirm understanding by asking questions.

TOPIC 4: Tenses — Simple Past and Simple Future

4.1 Simple Past Tense

The Simple Past Tense is used to describe completed actions, events, or situations that happened at a specific time in the past.

Sentence Type	Formula	Example
Affirmative	Subject + V2 (past form)	She visited the museum yesterday.
Negative	Subject + did not + V1	She did not visit the museum.
Interrogative	Did + Subject + V1?	Did she visit the museum?
W-H Question	Wh-word + did + Subject + V1?	Where did she go yesterday?

4.2 Uses of Simple Past

- Completed actions: I finished my homework. / The war ended in 1945.
- Series of past events: She woke up, brushed her teeth, and went to school.
- Past habits (used to): He played cricket every weekend. (when he was young)
- Historical facts: India gained independence in 1947.

4.3 Common Irregular Verbs (Past Form)

Base Form	Past Form	Past Participle
go	went	gone
write	wrote	written
speak	spoke	spoken
take	took	taken
come	came	come
eat	ate	eaten
make	made	made
give	gave	given
see	saw	seen
buy	bought	bought
think	thought	thought
begin	began	begun

4.4 Simple Future Tense

The Simple Future Tense expresses actions that will happen in the future.

Sentence Type	Formula	Example
Affirmative	Subject + will + V1	She will join college next year.
Negative	Subject + will not/won't + V1	She will not join college.

Interrogative	Will + Subject + V1?	Will she join college?
W-H Question	Wh-word + will + Subject + V1?	When will she join college?

4.5 Uses of Simple Future

- Predictions: It will rain tomorrow.
- Promises: I will help you with the project.
- Decisions made at the moment: I'll have the pizza, please.
- Offers: I will carry your bag.
- Requests: Will you please open the window?

4.6 Will vs Going to

Will	Going to
For spontaneous decisions (at the moment)	For planned decisions (already decided)
For predictions (without evidence)	For predictions (with evidence/signs)
I'll call you later.	I'm going to call him tomorrow (planned).
It will be sunny. (just my opinion)	Look at those clouds — it's going to rain.

TOPIC 5: Punctuation Marks

5.1 Common Punctuation Marks

Mark	Name	Use	Example
.	Full Stop (Period)	End of declarative/imperative sentence.	She is a doctor.
?	Question Mark	End of direct question.	Where are you going?
!	Exclamation Mark	After exclamation, strong emotion.	What a beautiful view!
,	Comma	Pause, list separation, joining clauses.	I bought milk, eggs, and bread.
;	Semicolon	Connects related independent clauses.	I love coffee; I drink it every day.
:	Colon	Introduces a list or explanation.	He needed three things: pen, paper, ink.
'	Apostrophe	Possession or contraction.	Rahul's book / don't = do not
"..."	Quotation Marks	Direct speech, titles, emphasis.	She said, "Hello there."
-	Hyphen	Joining compound words.	well-known, self-confident
—	Em Dash	Pause or additional information.	She arrived — hours late.
()	Parentheses/Brackets	Additional/supplementary info.	She (the teacher) arrived.
...	Ellipsis	Omission or pause in speech.	She waited... and waited.

5.2 Semicolon — Special Focus

The SEMICOLON (;) is more than a pause — it is stronger than a comma but weaker than a full stop.

Uses of Semicolon

Use	Example
To join two independent clauses	Life is short; art is long.
When two clauses contrast	She loves reading; her sister prefers music.
In lists with internal commas	Participants came from Mumbai, Maharashtra; Delhi, India; and London, UK.
Before conjunctive adverbs (however, therefore)	He studied hard; however, he did not pass.

5.3 Practice Exercises

Add correct punctuation:

1. rahul went to the market and bought vegetables fruits and milk
2. where are you going asked the teacher
3. i will meet you tomorrow i promise
4. she said i will come tomorrow
5. the doctor examined the patient he found nothing wrong

Answers

1. Rahul went to the market and bought vegetables, fruits, and milk.
2. "Where are you going?" asked the teacher.
3. "I will meet you tomorrow, I promise."
4. She said, "I will come tomorrow."
5. The doctor examined the patient; he found nothing wrong.

TOPIC 6: Writing Skills — Reports, Paragraphs, Summaries

6.1 Paragraph Writing

A paragraph is a group of sentences about ONE main idea. It has three parts: Topic Sentence (main idea), Supporting Sentences (details/examples), and Concluding Sentence.

6.2 Report Writing

Format of a Report:

Title: [Clear title of the report]

Prepared by: [Author name]

Date: [Date]

1. Introduction
[Background, purpose of report]
2. Main Findings / Body
[Key information, data, analysis]
3. Conclusion
[Summary of findings]
4. Recommendations (if required)
[Suggested actions based on findings]

6.3 Summary Writing

A summary is a condensed version of a longer text in your own words. Steps:

6. Read the passage carefully.
7. Identify the main ideas.
8. Remove examples and repetitions.
9. Write in your own words.
10. Write in about 1/3 of the original length.
11. Use past tense and third person.

6.4 Notice Writing

FORMAT:

[Name of Institution/Organization]

NOTICE

Date: Notice No.:

Subject: [Brief subject]

[Body of notice — who, what, when, where]

[Name]

[Designation]

[Signature]

QUICK REVISION SUMMARY — Subject 7: English Communication

Topic	Key Points
Communication	Exchange of information. Elements: Sender, Message, Channel, Receiver, Feedback.
Types	Verbal/Non-verbal, Formal/Informal, Written/Oral, Upward/Downward/Horizontal.
Formal Letter	Address, Date, Subject, Salutation, Body, Closing, Signature. Use: Dear Sir/Madam.
Barriers	Physical, Semantic, Psychological, Cultural, Organizational, Language barriers.
Simple Past	Subject + V2 (did/went/wrote). Used for completed past actions.
Simple Future	Subject + will + V1. Used for predictions, promises, spontaneous decisions.
Punctuation	Period(.), Comma(,), Semicolon(;), Colon(:), Question mark(?), Apostrophe(').
Semicolon	Joins independent clauses. Used before however/therefore. Stronger than comma.
Paragraph	Topic sentence + supporting details + conclusion.
Summary	Condensed version. Own words. 1/3 length. Past tense. Third person.

Exam Tips for English

- Always follow the correct format for letter/email/report writing.
- Use correct verb forms for past tense (irregular verbs must be memorized).
- Punctuation errors are common — practice placing commas, semicolons, apostrophes correctly.
- Semicolon: Remember to use before 'however', 'therefore', 'moreover', 'consequently'.
- Communication types: Formal vs Informal is a common question.
- Barriers to Communication: Always explain with examples.